

CSS Display: Table Complete Guide

CSS Educational Series

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Chapter 1

Introduction to CSS Display: Table

1.1 What is Display: Table?

The CSS `display: table` property allows you to create table-like layouts without using HTML `<table>` elements. This semantic-neutral approach provides flexible, responsive table layouts that can be easily converted between different display types.

1.1.1 Key Facts

- Converts any HTML element into a table-like display structure
- Works with `display: table-row`, `table-cell`, `table-column`, etc.
- No semantic table markup required
- Full control over spacing, borders, and alignment
- Responsive without media queries (in many cases)
- Universal browser support (IE8+)
- Perfect for legacy layout systems

1.1.2 The Display Table Family

Display Value	Behavior
<code>display: table</code>	Element behaves like <code><table></code>
<code>display: table-row</code>	Element behaves like <code><tr></code>
<code>display: table-cell</code>	Element behaves like <code><td></code> or <code><th></code>
<code>display: table-column</code>	Creates a virtual column
<code>display: table-row-group</code>	Element behaves like <code><tbody></code>
<code>display: table-header-group</code>	Element behaves like <code><thead></code>
<code>display: table-footer-group</code>	Element behaves like <code><tfoot></code>
<code>display: table-column-group</code>	Element behaves like <code><colgroup></code>
<code>display: table-caption</code>	Element behaves like <code><caption></code>

1.1.3 Use Cases

1. **Multi-column layouts:** Create equal-height columns without Flexbox
2. **Dashboard layouts:** Grid-like structures for complex UIs
3. **Data tables:** Display structured data without semantic tables
4. **Navigation menus:** Vertical menus with equal widths
5. **Pricing tables:** Product comparison layouts
6. **Legacy support:** Browsers that don't support Grid or Flexbox
7. **Complex headers:** Multi-line headers with alignment

1.1.4 Browser Support

Browser	Chrome	Firefox	Safari	Edge
display: table	All	All	All	All
table-* values	All	All	All	All
IE 8+	Full support	N/A	N/A	N/A

Chapter 2

Basic Syntax and Concepts

2.1 Fundamental Structure

```
1 <style>
2   /* Container acts like <table> */
3   .table-container {
4     display: table;
5     width: 100%;
6     border-collapse: collapse;
7   }
8
9   /* Row wrapper acts like <tr> */
10  .table-row {
11    display: table-row;
12  }
13
14  /* Cell acts like <td> */
15  .table-cell {
16    display: table-cell;
17    padding: 12px;
18    border: 1px solid #ddd;
19  }
20 </style>
21
22 <div class="table-container">
23   <div class="table-row">
24     <div class="table-cell">Cell 1</div>
25     <div class="table-cell">Cell 2</div>
26     <div class="table-cell">Cell 3</div>
27   </div>
28   <div class="table-row">
29     <div class="table-cell">Cell 4</div>
30     <div class="table-cell">Cell 5</div>
31     <div class="table-cell">Cell 6</div>
32   </div>
33 </div>
```

Listing 2.1: Basic Display Table Structure

2.2 Display: Table vs Actual Table Elements

Aspect	HTML <table>	display: table
Semantics	Table markup (semantic)	Div elements (neutral)
Flexibility	Limited styling options	Full CSS control
Responsive	Poor without modifications	Excellent with CSS
Browser support	Universal	IE8+
Use case	Data tables	Layout systems
Performance	Better for real tables	Better for layouts

2.3 Equal Height Columns

One major advantage: table-cell elements automatically have equal heights.

```

1 <style>
2   .equal-height-columns {
3     display: table;
4     width: 100%;
5     table-layout: fixed;
6   }
7
8   .column {
9     display: table-cell;
10    padding: 20px;
11    border: 1px solid #ccc;
12    vertical-align: top; /* Control vertical alignment */
13  }
14
15  .column-1 {
16    width: 25%;
17    background-color: #f0f0f0;
18  }
19
20  .column-2 {
21    width: 50%;
22    background-color: #ffffff;
23  }
24
25  .column-3 {
26    width: 25%;
27    background-color: #f5f5f5;
28  }
29 </style>
30
31 <div class="equal-height-columns">
32   <div class="column column-1">
33     <h3>Short</h3>
34     <p>This column has less content.</p>
35   </div>
36   <div class="column column-2">

```

```
37     <h3>Long Content</h3>
38     <p>This column has more content to demonstrate equal heights across
      all columns regardless of content length.</p>
39 </div>
40 <div class="column column-3">
41     <h3>Medium</h3>
42     <p>This has medium content.</p>
43     <p>All columns stretch to same height.</p>
44 </div>
45 </div>
```

Listing 2.2: Equal Height Columns Without Flexbox

Chapter 3

Practical Applications

3.1 Data Display Table

```
1 <style>
2   .data-table {
3     display: table;
4     width: 100%;
5     border-collapse: collapse;
6     background-color: white;
7     box-shadow: 0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);
8   }
9
10  .table-header {
11    display: table-row-group;
12    background-color: #2c3e50;
13    color: white;
14    font-weight: 600;
15  }
16
17  .table-body {
18    display: table-row-group;
19  }
20
21  .table-footer {
22    display: table-footer-group;
23    background-color: #ecf0f1;
24    font-weight: 500;
25  }
26
27  .table-row {
28    display: table-row;
29    border-bottom: 1px solid #ecf0f1;
30    transition: background-color 0.2s ease;
31  }
32
33  .table-row:hover {
34    background-color: #f8f9fa;
35  }
36
```

```

37     .table-cell {
38         display: table-cell;
39         padding: 16px;
40         vertical-align: middle;
41         border-right: 1px solid #ecf0f1;
42     }
43
44     .table-cell:last-child {
45         border-right: none;
46     }
47
48     .header-cell {
49         display: table-cell;
50         padding: 16px;
51         vertical-align: middle;
52         border-right: 1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.2);
53     }
54
55     .header-cell:last-child {
56         border-right: none;
57     }
58 </style>
59
60 <div class="data-table">
61     <div class="table-header">
62         <div class="table-row">
63             <div class="header-cell">Product</div>
64             <div class="header-cell">Category</div>
65             <div class="header-cell">Price</div>
66             <div class="header-cell">Stock</div>
67         </div>
68     </div>
69     <div class="table-body">
70         <div class="table-row">
71             <div class="table-cell">Laptop Pro</div>
72             <div class="table-cell">Electronics</div>
73             <div class="table-cell">$999</div>
74             <div class="table-cell">45</div>
75         </div>
76         <div class="table-row">
77             <div class="table-cell">Wireless Mouse</div>
78             <div class="table-cell">Accessories</div>
79             <div class="table-cell">$29</div>
80             <div class="table-cell">120</div>
81         </div>
82         <div class="table-row">
83             <div class="table-cell">USB Cable</div>
84             <div class="table-cell">Cables</div>
85             <div class="table-cell">$12</div>
86             <div class="table-cell">500</div>
87         </div>
88     </div>
89     <div class="table-footer">
90         <div class="table-row">

```

```
91         <div class="table-cell">Total Items</div>
92         <div class="table-cell">-</div>
93         <div class="table-cell">-</div>
94         <div class="table-cell">665</div>
95     </div>
96 </div>
97 </div>
```

Listing 3.1: Data Display with display: table

3.2 Pricing Table

```
1 <style>
2   .pricing-table {
3     display: table;
4     width: 100%;
5     background-color: #f8f9fa;
6     border-radius: 8px;
7     overflow: hidden;
8   }
9
10  .pricing-row {
11    display: table-row;
12  }
13
14  .pricing-cell {
15    display: table-cell;
16    padding: 20px;
17    border-right: 1px solid #ddd;
18    vertical-align: middle;
19    text-align: center;
20  }
21
22  .pricing-cell:last-child {
23    border-right: none;
24  }
25
26  .pricing-feature {
27    display: table-cell;
28    padding: 16px 20px;
29    text-align: left;
30    border-right: 1px solid #ddd;
31    font-weight: 500;
32    background-color: white;
33  }
34
35  .pricing-feature:last-child {
36    border-right: none;
37  }
38
39  .plan-header {
40    background-color: #2c3e50;
```

```

41     color: white;
42     font-size: 18px;
43     font-weight: 600;
44 }
45
46 .plan-price {
47     font-size: 32px;
48     font-weight: bold;
49     color: #27ae60;
50     padding: 24px 20px;
51 }
52
53 .plan-button {
54     padding: 12px 24px;
55     background-color: #3498db;
56     color: white;
57     border: none;
58     border-radius: 4px;
59     cursor: pointer;
60     font-weight: 600;
61     transition: background-color 0.2s;
62 }
63
64 .plan-button:hover {
65     background-color: #2980b9;
66 }
67
68 .checkmark {
69     color: #27ae60;
70     font-size: 20px;
71 }
72
73 .x-mark {
74     color: #e74c3c;
75     font-size: 20px;
76 }
77 </style>
78
79 <div class="pricing-table">
80     <div class="pricing-row">
81         <div class="pricing-feature" style="width: 25%;">Features</div>
82         <div class="pricing-cell" style="width: 25%;">
83             <div class="plan-header">Starter</div>
84             <div class="plan-price">\$29</div>
85             <button class="plan-button">Choose</button>
86         </div>
87         <div class="pricing-cell" style="width: 25%;">
88             <div class="plan-header">Pro</div>
89             <div class="plan-price">\$79</div>
90             <button class="plan-button">Choose</button>
91         </div>
92         <div class="pricing-cell" style="width: 25%;">
93             <div class="plan-header">Enterprise</div>
94             <div class="plan-price">\$199</div>

```

```

95         <button class="plan-button">Choose</button>
96     </div>
97 </div>
98
99 <div class="pricing-row">
100     <div class="pricing-feature">Users</div>
101     <div class="pricing-cell">1</div>
102     <div class="pricing-cell">5</div>
103     <div class="pricing-cell">Unlimited</div>
104 </div>
105
106 <div class="pricing-row">
107     <div class="pricing-feature">Storage</div>
108     <div class="pricing-cell">10GB</div>
109     <div class="pricing-cell">100GB</div>
110     <div class="pricing-cell">Unlimited</div>
111 </div>
112
113 <div class="pricing-row">
114     <div class="pricing-feature">API Access</div>
115     <div class="pricing-cell"><span class="x-mark "></span></div>
116     <div class="pricing-cell"><span class="checkmark "></span></div>
117     <div class="pricing-cell"><span class="checkmark "></span></div>
118 </div>
119
120 <div class="pricing-row">
121     <div class="pricing-feature">Support</div>
122     <div class="pricing-cell">Email</div>
123     <div class="pricing-cell">Priority</div>
124     <div class="pricing-cell">24/7 Phone</div>
125 </div>
126 </div>

```

Listing 3.2: Pricing Comparison Table

3.3 Dashboard Layout

```

1 <style>
2     .dashboard {
3         display: table;
4         width: 100%;
5         min-height: 100vh;
6         background-color: #f5f7fa;
7     }
8
9     .sidebar {
10         display: table-cell;
11         width: 250px;
12         background-color: #2c3e50;
13         color: white;
14         padding: 20px;
15         vertical-align: top;

```

```
16 }
17
18 .main-content {
19     display: table-cell;
20     padding: 20px;
21     vertical-align: top;
22 }
23
24 .sidebar h2 {
25     margin-top: 0;
26     font-size: 20px;
27 }
28
29 .sidebar-menu {
30     list-style: none;
31     padding: 0;
32     margin: 20px 0 0 0;
33 }
34
35 .sidebar-menu li {
36     margin-bottom: 10px;
37 }
38
39 .sidebar-menu a {
40     color: rgba(255,255,255,0.8);
41     text-decoration: none;
42     display: block;
43     padding: 10px;
44     border-radius: 4px;
45     transition: background-color 0.2s;
46 }
47
48 .sidebar-menu a:hover,
49 .sidebar-menu a.active {
50     background-color: #34495e;
51     color: white;
52 }
53
54 .widgets {
55     display: table;
56     width: 100%;
57 }
58
59 .widget-row {
60     display: table-row;
61 }
62
63 .widget {
64     display: table-cell;
65     padding: 15px;
66     background-color: white;
67     border-radius: 8px;
68     box-shadow: 0 2px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);
69     margin-right: 15px;
```

```

70     vertical-align: top;
71 }
72
73 .widget:last-child {
74     margin-right: 0;
75 }
76
77 .widget h3 {
78     margin-top: 0;
79     color: #2c3e50;
80 }
81
82 .widget-value {
83     font-size: 28px;
84     font-weight: bold;
85     color: #27ae60;
86 }
87 </style>
88
89 <div class="dashboard">
90     <div class="sidebar">
91         <h2>Dashboard</h2>
92         <ul class="sidebar-menu">
93             <li><a href="#" class="active">Overview</a></li>
94             <li><a href="#">Analytics</a></li>
95             <li><a href="#">Reports</a></li>
96             <li><a href="#">Settings</a></li>
97         </ul>
98     </div>
99     <div class="main-content">
100         <h1>Welcome back!</h1>
101         <div class="widgets">
102             <div class="widget-row">
103                 <div class="widget" style="width: 33.33%;">
104                     <h3>Total Revenue</h3>
105                     <div class="widget-value">\$45,230</div>
106                 </div>
107                 <div class="widget" style="width: 33.33%;">
108                     <h3>Active Users</h3>
109                     <div class="widget-value">1,234</div>
110                 </div>
111                 <div class="widget" style="width: 33.33%;">
112                     <h3>Conversion Rate</h3>
113                     <div class="widget-value">3.8%</div>
114                 </div>
115             </div>
116         </div>
117     </div>
118 </div>

```

Listing 3.3: Dashboard with Table Layout

Chapter 4

Advanced Techniques

4.1 Responsive Table Conversion

```
1 <style>
2   .responsive-table {
3     display: table;
4     width: 100%;
5     border-collapse: collapse;
6   }
7
8   .table-row {
9     display: table-row;
10  }
11
12  .table-cell {
13    display: table-cell;
14    padding: 12px;
15    border: 1px solid #ddd;
16    vertical-align: top;
17  }
18
19  /* Mobile: Switch to block layout */
20  @media (max-width: 768px) {
21    .responsive-table {
22      display: block;
23    }
24
25    .table-row {
26      display: block;
27      margin-bottom: 12px;
28      border: 1px solid #ddd;
29      border-radius: 4px;
30      overflow: hidden;
31    }
32
33    .table-cell {
34      display: block;
35      padding: 8px 12px;
36      border: none;
```



```

37         border-bottom: 1px solid #eee;
38     }
39
40     .table-cell:last-child {
41         border-bottom: none;
42     }
43
44     /* Show labels for mobile */
45     .table-cell::before {
46         content: attr(data-label);
47         font-weight: 600;
48         color: #2c3e50;
49         display: block;
50         margin-bottom: 4px;
51     }
52 }
53 </style>
54
55 <div class="responsive-table">
56     <div class="table-row">
57         <div class="table-cell" data-label="Product">Laptop Pro</div>
58         <div class="table-cell" data-label="Price">\$999</div>
59         <div class="table-cell" data-label="Stock">45</div>
60     </div>
61     <div class="table-row">
62         <div class="table-cell" data-label="Product">Mouse</div>
63         <div class="table-cell" data-label="Price">\$29</div>
64         <div class="table-cell" data-label="Stock">120</div>
65     </div>
66 </div>

```

Listing 4.1: Responsive Table with Media Queries

4.2 Table Layout Algorithm

```

1 <style>
2     /* Automatic layout (default) */
3     .table-auto {
4         display: table;
5         table-layout: auto; /* Content determines width */
6         width: 100%;
7     }
8
9     /* Fixed layout (faster rendering) */
10    .table-fixed {
11        display: table;
12        table-layout: fixed; /* Column widths are predetermined */
13        width: 100%;
14    }
15
16    .table-auto .cell {
17        display: table-cell;

```

```

18     padding: 12px;
19     border: 1px solid #ddd;
20 }
21
22 .table-fixed .cell {
23     display: table-cell;
24     padding: 12px;
25     border: 1px solid #ddd;
26 }
27 </style>
28
29 <!-- Auto layout: cells size based on content -->
30 <div class="table-auto">
31     <div style="display: table-row;">
32         <div class="cell">Short</div>
33         <div class="cell">This cell has much longer content</div>
34     </div>
35 </div>
36
37 <!-- Fixed layout: columns have predefined widths -->
38 <div class="table-fixed">
39     <div style="display: table-row;">
40         <div class="cell" style="width: 30%;">Col 1</div>
41         <div class="cell" style="width: 70%;">Col 2</div>
42     </div>
43 </div>

```

Listing 4.2: Table-Layout Property

4.3 Nested Tables

```

1 <style>
2     .outer-table {
3         display: table;
4         width: 100%;
5         border: 2px solid #333;
6     }
7
8     .outer-row {
9         display: table-row;
10    }
11
12    .outer-cell {
13        display: table-cell;
14        padding: 20px;
15        border: 1px solid #ddd;
16        width: 50%;
17    }
18
19    .inner-table {
20        display: table;
21        width: 100%;

```

```
22     border: 1px solid #999;
23 }
24
25 .inner-row {
26     display: table-row;
27 }
28
29 .inner-cell {
30     display: table-cell;
31     padding: 10px;
32     border: 1px solid #ccc;
33     background-color: #f9f9f9;
34 }
35 </style>
36
37 <div class="outer-table">
38     <div class="outer-row">
39         <div class="outer-cell">
40             <h3>Section 1</h3>
41             <div class="inner-table">
42                 <div class="inner-row">
43                     <div class="inner-cell">Item 1</div>
44                     <div class="inner-cell">Value 1</div>
45                 </div>
46                 <div class="inner-row">
47                     <div class="inner-cell">Item 2</div>
48                     <div class="inner-cell">Value 2</div>
49                 </div>
50             </div>
51         </div>
52         <div class="outer-cell">
53             <h3>Section 2</h3>
54             <p>Content here</p>
55         </div>
56     </div>
57 </div>
```

Listing 4.3: Nested Table Structures

4.4 Vertical Alignment Techniques

```
1 <style>
2     .alignment-table {
3         display: table;
4         width: 100%;
5         height: 200px;
6     }
7
8     .alignment-row {
9         display: table-row;
10    }
11
```

```

12 .cell-top {
13     display: table-cell;
14     vertical-align: top;
15     padding: 20px;
16     border: 1px solid #ddd;
17     background-color: #f0f0f0;
18 }
19
20 .cell-middle {
21     display: table-cell;
22     vertical-align: middle;
23     padding: 20px;
24     border: 1px solid #ddd;
25     background-color: #f5f5f5;
26 }
27
28 .cell-bottom {
29     display: table-cell;
30     vertical-align: bottom;
31     padding: 20px;
32     border: 1px solid #ddd;
33     background-color: #fafafa;
34 }
35
36 .cell-baseline {
37     display: table-cell;
38     vertical-align: baseline;
39     padding: 20px;
40     border: 1px solid #ddd;
41     background-color: #ffffff;
42 }
43 </style>
44
45 <div class="alignment-table">
46     <div class="alignment-row">
47         <div class="cell-top">
48             <h3>Top Aligned</h3>
49             <p>Content starts from top</p>
50         </div>
51         <div class="cell-middle">
52             <h3>Middle Aligned</h3>
53             <p>Content centered vertically</p>
54         </div>
55         <div class="cell-bottom">
56             <h3>Bottom Aligned</h3>
57             <p>Content at bottom</p>
58         </div>
59         <div class="cell-baseline">
60             <h3>Baseline</h3>
61             <p>Aligned to text baseline</p>
62         </div>
63     </div>
64 </div>

```

Listing 4.4: Vertical Alignment in Table Cells

Chapter 5

Real-World Examples

5.1 Complete Product Listing

```
1 <style>
2   .product-listing {
3     display: table;
4     width: 100%;
5     background: white;
6     border-radius: 8px;
7     overflow: hidden;
8     box-shadow: 0 2px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);
9   }
10
11   .product-header {
12     display: table-row;
13     background: linear-gradient(135deg, #667eea 0%, #764ba2 100%);
14     color: white;
15     font-weight: 600;
16   }
17
18   .product-body {
19     display: table-row-group;
20   }
21
22   .product-row {
23     display: table-row;
24     border-bottom: 1px solid #ecf0f1;
25     transition: background-color 0.2s;
26   }
27
28   .product-row:hover {
29     background-color: #f8f9fa;
30   }
31
32   .product-cell {
33     display: table-cell;
34     padding: 16px 20px;
35     vertical-align: middle;
36     border-right: 1px solid #ecf0f1;
```

```
37     }
38
39     .product-cell:last-child {
40         border-right: none;
41     }
42
43     .header-cell {
44         display: table-cell;
45         padding: 16px 20px;
46         vertical-align: middle;
47         border-right: 1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.2);
48     }
49
50     .header-cell:last-child {
51         border-right: none;
52     }
53
54     .product-image {
55         width: 60px;
56         height: 60px;
57         background-color: #ecf0f1;
58         border-radius: 4px;
59     }
60
61     .product-info h4 {
62         margin: 0 0 4px 0;
63         color: #2c3e50;
64     }
65
66     .product-info p {
67         margin: 0;
68         color: #95a5a6;
69         font-size: 12px;
70     }
71
72     .price {
73         font-size: 18px;
74         font-weight: 700;
75         color: #27ae60;
76     }
77
78     .status-badge {
79         display: inline-block;
80         padding: 4px 12px;
81         border-radius: 12px;
82         font-size: 12px;
83         font-weight: 600;
84     }
85
86     .badge-in-stock {
87         background-color: #d4edda;
88         color: #155724;
89     }
90
```

```

91     .badge-low-stock {
92         background-color: #fff3cd;
93         color: #856404;
94     }
95
96     .action-button {
97         padding: 8px 16px;
98         background-color: #3498db;
99         color: white;
100        border: none;
101        border-radius: 4px;
102        cursor: pointer;
103        font-size: 12px;
104        transition: background-color 0.2s;
105    }
106
107    .action-button:hover {
108        background-color: #2980b9;
109    }
110 </style>
111
112 <div class="product-listing">
113     <div class="product-header">
114         <div class="header-cell" style="width: 10%;">Image</div>
115         <div class="header-cell" style="width: 30%;">Product</div>
116         <div class="header-cell" style="width: 15%;">Price</div>
117         <div class="header-cell" style="width: 20%;">Status</div>
118         <div class="header-cell" style="width: 25%;">Action</div>
119     </div>
120
121     <div class="product-body">
122         <div class="product-row">
123             <div class="product-cell" style="width: 10%;">
124                 <div class="product-image"></div>
125             </div>
126             <div class="product-cell" style="width: 30%;">
127                 <div class="product-info">
128                     <h4>Premium Headphones</h4>
129                     <p>Wireless, noise-cancelling</p>
130                 </div>
131             </div>
132             <div class="product-cell" style="width: 15%;">
133                 <div class="price">\$249</div>
134             </div>
135             <div class="product-cell" style="width: 20%;">
136                 <span class="status-badge badge-in-stock">In Stock</span>
137             </div>
138             <div class="product-cell" style="width: 25%;">
139                 <button class="action-button">Add to Cart</button>
140             </div>
141         </div>
142
143         <div class="product-row">
144             <div class="product-cell" style="width: 10%;">

```



```

145         <div class="product-image"></div>
146     </div>
147     <div class="product-cell" style="width: 30%;">
148         <div class="product-info">
149             <h4>USB-C Hub</h4>
150             <p>7-in-1 multiport adapter</p>
151         </div>
152     </div>
153     <div class="product-cell" style="width: 15%;">
154         <div class="price">\$49</div>
155     </div>
156     <div class="product-cell" style="width: 20%;">
157         <span class="status-badger badge-low-stock">Low Stock</span>
158     </div>
159     <div class="product-cell" style="width: 25%;">
160         <button class="action-button">Add to Cart</button>
161     </div>
162 </div>
163 </div>
164 </div>

```

Listing 5.1: Product Listing with Table Display

5.2 Form Layout with Table Display

```

1 <style>
2   .form-table {
3     display: table;
4     width: 100%;
5     gap: 20px;
6   }
7
8   .form-row {
9     display: table-row;
10  }
11
12  .form-col {
13    display: table-cell;
14    padding: 16px;
15    vertical-align: top;
16  }
17
18  .form-col.col-1 {
19    width: 50%;
20  }
21
22  .form-col.col-2 {
23    width: 50%;
24  }
25
26  .form-group {
27    margin-bottom: 16px;

```

```
28 }
29
30 .form-group label {
31     display: block;
32     margin-bottom: 6px;
33     font-weight: 600;
34     color: #2c3e50;
35 }
36
37 .form-group input,
38 .form-group select {
39     width: 100%;
40     padding: 10px 12px;
41     border: 1px solid #ddd;
42     border-radius: 4px;
43     font-family: inherit;
44     font-size: 14px;
45 }
46
47 .form-group input:focus,
48 .form-group select:focus {
49     outline: none;
50     border-color: #3498db;
51     box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(52, 152, 219, 0.1);
52 }
53
54 .full-width {
55     display: table;
56     width: 100%;
57 }
58
59 .full-width .form-col {
60     width: 100%;
61 }
62
63 .button-group {
64     margin-top: 24px;
65     display: flex;
66     gap: 12px;
67     justify-content: flex-end;
68 }
69
70 .button-group button {
71     padding: 12px 24px;
72     border: 1px solid #ddd;
73     border-radius: 4px;
74     cursor: pointer;
75     font-size: 14px;
76     font-weight: 600;
77     transition: all 0.2s;
78 }
79
80 .button-group button.primary {
81     background-color: #3498db;
```

```

82     color: white;
83     border-color: #3498db;
84 }
85
86 .button-group button.primary:hover {
87     background-color: #2980b9;
88 }
89 </style>
90
91 <form class="form-table">
92     <div class="form-row">
93         <div class="form-col col-1">
94             <div class="form-group">
95                 <label>First Name</label>
96                 <input type="text" placeholder="John" />
97             </div>
98         </div>
99         <div class="form-col col-2">
100             <div class="form-group">
101                 <label>Last Name</label>
102                 <input type="text" placeholder="Doe" />
103             </div>
104         </div>
105     </div>
106
107     <div class="form-row">
108         <div class="form-col col-1">
109             <div class="form-group">
110                 <label>Email</label>
111                 <input type="email" placeholder="john@example.com" />
112             </div>
113         </div>
114         <div class="form-col col-2">
115             <div class="form-group">
116                 <label>Phone</label>
117                 <input type="tel" placeholder="+1 (555) 000-0000" />
118             </div>
119         </div>
120     </div>
121
122     <div class="full-width">
123         <div class="form-row">
124             <div class="form-col">
125                 <div class="form-group">
126                     <label>Message</label>
127                     <textarea style="width: 100%; padding: 10px 12px; border:
128                         1px solid #ddd; border-radius: 4px; font-family:
129                         inherit;" rows="5"></textarea>
130                 </div>
131             </div>
132         </div>
133     </div>
134
135     <div class="button-group">

```

```
134         <button type="reset">Clear</button>
135         <button type="submit" class="primary">Submit</button>
136     </div>
137 </form>
```

Listing 5.2: Multi-Column Form Layout

Chapter 6

CSS Properties for Table Display

6.1 Border Collapse and Spacing

```
1 <style>
2   /* With border-collapse: collapse */
3   .table-collapsed {
4       display: table;
5       border-collapse: collapse;
6       width: 100%;
7   }
8
9   .table-collapsed div {
10      display: table-cell;
11      padding: 12px;
12      border: 1px solid #333;
13  }
14
15  /* With border-collapse: separate */
16  .table-separated {
17      display: table;
18      border-collapse: separate;
19      border-spacing: 10px;
20      width: 100%;
21  }
22
23  .table-separated div {
24      display: table-cell;
25      padding: 12px;
26      border: 1px solid #333;
27  }
28
29  /* Without border-collapse (defaults to separate) */
30  .table-default {
31      display: table;
32      border-spacing: 0;
33      width: 100%;
34  }
35
36  .table-default div {
```

```

37     display: table-cell;
38     padding: 12px;
39     border: 1px solid #333;
40 }
41 </style>
42
43 <!-- Borders collapse: no space between -->
44 <div class="table-collapsed">
45     <div>Cell 1</div>
46     <div>Cell 2</div>
47 </div>
48
49 <!-- Borders separate: with spacing -->
50 <div class="table-separated">
51     <div>Cell 1</div>
52     <div>Cell 2</div>
53 </div>

```

Listing 6.1: Border Handling in Table Display

6.2 Width and Height

```

1 <style>
2     .sized-table {
3         display: table;
4         width: 100%;
5         height: 300px;
6     }
7
8     .sized-row {
9         display: table-row;
10        height: 100px;
11    }
12
13    .sized-cell {
14        display: table-cell;
15        width: 33.33%;
16        vertical-align: middle;
17        text-align: center;
18        border: 1px solid #ddd;
19    }
20
21    /* Content fills available space */
22    .fill-space {
23        display: table;
24        width: 100%;
25        height: 400px;
26    }
27
28    .fill-space > div {
29        display: table-row;
30        height: 1px; /* Distributes equally */

```

```
31     }
32
33     .fill-space .cell {
34         display: table-cell;
35         padding: 20px;
36         border: 1px solid #ddd;
37     }
38 </style>
39
40 <div class="sized-table">
41     <div class="sized-row">
42         <div class="sized-cell">Cell 1</div>
43         <div class="sized-cell">Cell 2</div>
44         <div class="sized-cell">Cell 3</div>
45     </div>
46 </div>
```

Listing 6.2: Sizing Table Elements

Chapter 7

Browser Compatibility

7.1 Universal Support

CSS Display Table values have universal support across all modern browsers:

Browser	Version	Support	Notes
Chrome	All	Full	No issues
Firefox	All	Full	No issues
Safari	All	Full	No issues
Edge	All	Full	No issues
IE	8+	Full	Full support
IE	7	Partial	Limited support

7.2 Fallbacks

```
1  /* Modern browsers: Use display: table */
2  .layout {
3      display: table;
4      width: 100%;
5  }
6
7  .column {
8      display: table-cell;
9  }
10
11 /* Fallback for very old browsers */
12 @media screen and (max-width: 0px) {
13     .layout {
14         display: block;
15     }
16
17     .column {
18         display: block;
19         width: 100%;
20     }
21 }
```

Listing 7.1: Progressive Enhancement

Chapter 8

When NOT to Use Display: Table

8.1 Better Alternatives

- **CSS Grid:** For complex, multi-dimensional layouts
- **Flexbox:** For one-dimensional layouts with wrapping
- **HTML tables:** For actual tabular data with semantics
- **CSS columns:** For text flowing into multiple columns

8.2 Comparison Table

Use Case	HTML Table	display: table	CSS Grid
Data presentation	Yes	No	No
Layout structure	No	Yes	Yes
Responsive	Difficult	Easy	Easy
Semantics	Important	Neutral	Neutral

Chapter 9

Quick Reference and Cheat Sheet

9.1 Property Reference

```
1  /* Container properties */
2  display: table;
3  border-collapse: collapse | separate;
4  border-spacing: <length>;
5  width: <value>;
6  height: <value>;
7  table-layout: auto | fixed;
8
9  /* Row properties */
10 display: table-row;
11 height: <value>;
12
13 /* Cell properties */
14 display: table-cell;
15 width: <value>;
16 vertical-align: top | middle | bottom | baseline;
17 padding: <value>;
18 border: <value>;
19
20 /* Row group properties */
21 display: table-row-group;      /* <tbody> */
22 display: table-header-group; /* <thead> */
23 display: table-footer-group; /* <tfoot> */
24
25 /* Column properties */
26 display: table-column;
27 display: table-column-group;
28 width: <value>; /* Applies to whole column */
29
30 /* Caption */
31 display: table-caption;
32 caption-side: top | bottom;
```

Listing 9.1: Display Table Properties Cheat Sheet

9.2 Common Patterns

- Equal-height columns without Flexbox/Grid
- Data table layouts
- Pricing tables
- Dashboard layouts
- Form layouts with columns
- Navigation with consistent heights
- Product listing tables
- Legacy browser support (IE8+)

9.3 Best Practices

1. Use table-layout: fixed for better performance
2. Always set explicit widths on columns
3. Use border-collapse for cleaner borders
4. Combine with media queries for responsive design
5. Don't nest tables unnecessarily
6. Use semantic HTML first, display: table as layout fallback
7. Test across browsers for consistency
8. Consider accessibility when hiding content

Chapter 10

Conclusion

10.1 Summary

CSS Display: Table provides a powerful, widely-supported method for creating table-like layouts without using HTML table elements. With equal-height columns, flexible alignment options, and universal browser support, it remains a valuable tool in modern web development—especially when CSS Grid and Flexbox aren’t suitable or for supporting older browsers.

10.2 Key Advantages

- Universal browser support (IE8+)
- Easy equal-height column layouts
- Fine-grained vertical alignment control
- No semantic table markup needed
- Works with any HTML elements
- Responsive with media queries
- Excellent performance characteristics

10.3 Next Steps

Explore these related layout techniques:

- CSS Grid for complex layouts
- Flexbox for flexible, one-dimensional layouts
- CSS Columns for text flow
- HTML Tables for semantic data